CSS VISTA

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LEAD REPORT / INTERNATIONAL SECURITY

Missile exchanges widen Yemen–Saudi confrontation

Attacks on Aden and Saudi sites raised new concerns over civilian safety and regional transport routes.

On Saturday, 24 October 2026, Yemeni authorities reported new Houthi missile attacks on Aden, while Saudi authorities announced interceptions of ballistic missiles and warnings over falling debris. Yemen's transport ministry said Aden International Airport had come under missile attack again and described risks to civil aviation. The Houthis claimed attacks against military facilities in Aden and against airports and oil installations in Saudi Arabia.

Saudi civil-defence authorities reported intercepted missiles and falling debris in western regions. Houthi representatives disputed Saudi claims about the intended targets of missiles approaching the holy cities. Houthi-controlled media also alleged that Saudi-led air strikes killed civilians in Sanaa and Hodeida; those reported casualties were not independently verified in the cited coverage.

The exchanges followed renewed fighting in Yemen and threats to commercial transport around the wider Gulf and Red Sea. Claims about precise targets and battlefield losses came from parties to the conflict and must be distinguished from independently established facts.

BACKGROUND Yemen's conflict involves Houthi forces and the internationally recognised government, backed by a Saudi-led coalition. A fragile 2022 truce did not produce a comprehensive settlement.

ANALYSIS Missile attacks on airports, transport corridors and energy infrastructure can raise civilian risks beyond the immediate battlefield. Pakistan's diplomatic and energy interests make de-escalation and protected navigation significant.

REVISION POINTS

Aden serves as the seat of Yemen's internationally recognised government. | Saudi Arabia reported missile interceptions on 24 October; the Houthis disputed the target description. | Reported civilian casualties from air strikes remained claims made by Houthi media.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / International Relations — Red Sea security, Gulf stability and conflict diplomacy

SOURCES [1] · [2]

AT A GLANCE

Yemen and Saudi Arabia New missile claims and interceptions heightened risks to civilian transport and energy sites.

Pakistan's economic direction The finance minister reiterated an export-led strategy and tariff reform.

Border trade resumes The Gabd–Rimdan route reopened to commercial consignments.

Dam contract signed Wapda contracted Rs133.18bn in hydro-mechanical works for Diamer-Bhasha.

Biodiversity science A science–policy forum began during COP17 in Yerevan.

01 PAKISTAN

SBP POLICY RATE	USD/PKR INTERBANK	KSE-100
11.50%	276.82	162,374.87
Decision: 14 Sep 2026 [20]	Close: 23 Oct 2026 [21]	Close: 23 Oct 2026 [22]

ECONOMY / TRADE

Aurangzeb backs exports over demand-driven growth

The finance minister rejected a return to import-intensive expansion and committed to tariff reform.

On Saturday, 24 October 2026, Finance Minister Muhammad Aurangzeb told a Lahore gathering that Pakistan should pursue sustainable, export-led growth rather than another cycle driven by liquidity and consumption. He spoke at Lahore University of Management Sciences during an American Business Forum event.

Aurangzeb said the earlier pattern of demand growth frequently produced import pressure and balance-of-payments difficulties. He argued that long-lasting protection for domestic businesses had weakened competition and that tariff reforms needed to continue. The address linked trade competitiveness to reforms in energy pricing, taxation, regulation and access to finance.

According to the minister, Pakistan's external debt payments were expected to fall from $26.5 billion in the previous fiscal year to $21.5 billion in the current one. These figures were his reported estimates and are not presented as independently audited outcomes. He also identified population growth and climate-related stress as development challenges.

The minister called for improved conditions for investors, including greater consistency between federal and provincial rules. He portrayed confidence, productivity and jobs as connected issues rather than separate policy goals.

BACKGROUND Pakistan has repeatedly faced external financing pressure when imports and domestic demand increased faster than foreign-exchange earnings. Tariff design affects producer inputs, import competition and the incentives to export.

ANALYSIS Reducing tariff protection may benefit exporters who import inputs, but changes also create adjustment costs for firms shielded by older arrangements. The policy test will be whether businesses can raise productivity and gain reliable energy and market access.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Aurangzeb spoke at LUMS in Lahore on Saturday, 24 October.
2. He contrasted export-led growth with liquidity-fuelled consumption-led growth.
3. He cited $21.5bn in current-year external debt payments, compared with $26.5bn previously.

CSS ANGLE Pakistan Affairs / Economy — balance of payments, tariffs and industrial competitiveness

SOURCES [3]

FOREIGN TRADE / BALOCHISTAN

Pakistan reopens Gabd–Rimdan crossing with Iran

Commercial vehicles resumed movement at a Gwadar border point after an earlier suspension.

On Saturday, 24 October 2026, commercial movement resumed through the Gabd–Rimdan border crossing between Pakistan and Iran, according to border officials and Gwadar business representatives cited by Dawn. The crossing, also called Gate 250, lies in Gwadar district on the Pakistan side.

Officials allowed movement of consignments carrying older consignment notes, including trucks transporting liquefied petroleum gas and essential food products. Mir Naveed Jan Kalmati, president of the Gwadar Chamber of Commerce and Industry, confirmed the reopening and said that goods had begun to cross in both directions.

Trade at the Gabd–Rimdan and Taftan points had been suspended from 17 October. A subsequent attack on waiting freight vehicles increased concerns about convoy security. The reopening followed a local security review and deployment of additional protection arrangements.

Business representatives expect resumed trade to relieve logistical pressure. The immediate effect on national prices cannot be established from a single day of resumed shipments, however; import volumes and onward transport remain important.

BACKGROUND Gabd–Rimdan connects coastal Balochistan with Iran's Sistan and Baluchestan region. Formal border facilities facilitate customs, legal trade and movement of essential goods.

ANALYSIS A reliable border regime affects livelihoods and legal commerce. Predictable customs procedures and security for freight can also help limit incentives for informal trading channels.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Trade resumed at Gabd–Rimdan on 24 October.
2. The crossing is also known as Gate 250.
3. The prior suspension began on 17 October; Saturday's decision restored commercial movement.

CSS ANGLE Pakistan Affairs / International Relations — border management and Pakistan–Iran relations

SOURCES [4]

WATER / INFRASTRUCTURE

Wapda signs Rs133.18bn Diamer-Bhasha works contract

The agreement covers flow-control gates, steel structures and related hydro-mechanical systems.

On Saturday, 24 October 2026, the Water and Power Development Authority signed a Rs133.18 billion hydro-mechanical contract for the Diamer-Bhasha Dam project with the Power China–IKAN joint venture, according to Dawn's report of Wapda's announcement.

The HM-1 package provides for manufacturing, supplying and installing gates and structural steel that regulate water flows. Its scope also includes equipment at flushing tunnels, power intakes and outlets, together with steel lining, hoisting systems, pumps and associated electrical works.

Project director Arif Ali signed for Wapda and Ling Jianke signed for the joint venture. Wapda chairman Muhammad Saeed and representatives of the companies attended the ceremony. The project is being constructed on the Indus River about 40 kilometres downstream of Chilas.

Wapda reported that the completed project is designed for 8.1 million acre-feet of gross storage and installed generating capacity of 4,500 megawatts. Those are design capacities for the finished project, not electricity or water delivered on 24 October.

BACKGROUND Large multipurpose dams combine water storage, hydropower and regulation of river flows. Engineering contracts for gates and spillway systems are distinct from civil construction and electricity transmission.

ANALYSIS Water security depends on completion, sediment handling, distribution and safe operation, while added generation must connect reliably to the transmission network. Contract signing is a procurement milestone, not proof of finished capacity.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. The HM-1 contract value is Rs133.18bn.
2. The design figures cited are 8.1 MAF storage and 4,500 MW installed capacity.
3. The dam is located on the Indus roughly 40km downstream of Chilas.

CSS ANGLE General Science & Ability / Pakistan Affairs — hydropower, water storage and energy security

SOURCES [5]

GOVERNANCE / TRANSPORT

Railways orders safety emergency through 31 December

Leave restrictions, field inspections and daily engineering reports form part of the response.

On Saturday, 24 October 2026, Pakistan Railways announced a system-wide safety emergency on the direction of Railways Minister Muhammad Hanif Abbasi. Radio Pakistan said the measures included cancellation of field officers' leave and Sunday site visits to monitor train operations.

Officials were directed to use trains for official travel between cities, while civil and mechanical engineering heads were instructed to submit daily reports. The head of safety was also required to report daily. The emergency is scheduled to remain in force until 31 December 2026.

The announcement followed concerns about repeated accidents and derailments. Dawn reported that the minister sought the removal of operational deficiencies in rolling stock, infrastructure and signalling. A declared emergency can accelerate inspections, but physical repairs, enforcement and independent review determine whether accident risks actually decline.

The programme also draws attention to the division of responsibilities across track maintenance, operations and technical engineering. Regular reporting may make safety faults visible to the ministry, provided that findings produce corrective action.

BACKGROUND Rail safety involves track condition, signalling, vehicle maintenance, dispatch practices and staff compliance. Failures in several of these systems can interact to cause an incident.

ANALYSIS Emergency directions need measurable follow-through: inspected assets, repaired defects, accountable deadlines and published performance indicators. A fixed end date alone cannot establish a safety improvement.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. The emergency was announced on 24 October.
2. It is scheduled through 31 December 2026.

3. Daily reporting by engineering and safety officials was ordered.

CSS ANGLE Governance / Pakistan Affairs — public-sector safety regulation and administrative accountability

SOURCES [6] · [7]

ECONOMIC DIPLOMACY

Pakistan and Canada conclude third investment-treaty round

Negotiators advanced discussions but had not announced a final bilateral treaty.

On Saturday, 24 October 2026, Pakistan and Canada concluded the third round of their bilateral investment treaty negotiations in Islamabad, according to a Government of Pakistan Press Information Department release.

The Board of Investment said the talks aimed to establish a balanced legal framework for investment and improve long-term business confidence. Federal Minister for the Board of Investment Qaiser Ahmed Sheikh and Canadian High Commissioner Tariq Ali Khan attended the concluding event.

Dawn reported that the negotiations addressed direct and indirect investment, portfolio investment, performance requirements, expropriation, third-party funding and investor–state dispute settlement. Canadian official Daphnee Campeau and Pakistan's additional secretary for law and justice, Khashih ur Rehman, headed the respective teams.

The announcement described progress in negotiations, not a signed or ratified treaty. Any agreement would still need an agreed text and completion of applicable domestic procedures before becoming operative.

BACKGROUND Bilateral investment treaties establish rules about foreign investment and commonly include standards for treatment, protection and the resolution of disputes. Their exact scope depends on negotiated language.

ANALYSIS Investor confidence can benefit from legal predictability. The public-policy challenge is preserving regulatory discretion while establishing credible protections and proportionate dispute processes.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. The third Pakistan–Canada BIT round ended on 24 October.
2. The meeting took place in Islamabad.
3. Investor–state dispute settlement was among the subjects discussed, according to Dawn.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / Economy — investment treaties and commercial diplomacy

SOURCES [8] · [9]

BORDER SECURITY / DIPLOMACY

Islamabad rejects Kabul statement on cross-border militancy

Pakistan called for verifiable action against armed networks; Afghan authorities denied seeking instability.

On Saturday, 24 October 2026, Pakistan's Ministry of Information and Broadcasting rejected recent assertions by Afghanistan's Taliban authorities that they lacked the interest or capability to cause insecurity in Pakistan. The ministry said cross-border militancy remained a central obstacle to bilateral confidence.

Pakistan referred to international monitoring assessments while alleging that armed organisations used Afghan territory to support attacks across the border. These allegations were presented by Islamabad as its official security position. The Afghan administration's spokesperson, Zabihullah Mujahid, had denied that Kabul wanted to support instability in Pakistan.

The Pakistani ministry stressed that its security measures were directed at armed threats rather than Afghan civilians. It said any improvement in relations required credible commitments and demonstrable steps against militant sanctuaries and infiltration.

The exchange shows the continuing difficulty of separating border-management measures, intelligence claims and diplomatic engagement. Independent examination of incidents and regular communication are necessary to evaluate competing official narratives.

BACKGROUND Pakistan and Afghanistan share a long border with significant cross-border trade, population movement and security concerns. Armed-group allegations have repeatedly affected bilateral negotiations.

ANALYSIS Measures affecting borders and trade carry costs for communities on both sides. Sustained reductions in violence will depend on verification arrangements and incentives for practical cooperation, not on statements alone.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Islamabad issued its rebuttal on Saturday, 24 October.
2. The Pakistani statement called for verifiable measures against armed networks.
3. Afghan Taliban authorities denied seeking to destabilise Pakistan.

CSS ANGLE Current Affairs / Pakistan Affairs — Pakistan–Afghanistan security and diplomacy

SOURCES [10] · [11]

02 WORLD

MULTILATERAL INSTITUTIONS

UN marks 81 years with renewed cooperation appeal

António Guterres connected diplomacy, human rights and collective responses to conflict and climate stress.

On Saturday, 24 October 2026, the United Nations marked the 81st anniversary of the UN Charter entering into force. Secretary-General António Guterres issued a United Nations Day message calling on governments to reaffirm international law, dialogue and cooperation.

The message referred to wars, climate disruption, inequality and rapidly changing technology as shared problems requiring collective action. It described the UN's continuing work in diplomacy, hunger reduction, human rights and emergency assistance. The secretary-general urged member states to strengthen rather than abandon shared obligations.

The United Nations in Malawi released a separate statement on the same date, tying multilateral priorities to inclusive development,

BACKGROUND The UN Charter came into force on 24 October 1945. Its institutional framework includes the General Assembly, Security Council, International Court of Justice and UN Secretariat.

ANALYSIS Multilateral institutions can create common rules and channels for coordination, but their effectiveness depends on political cooperation and member-state compliance. The anniversary called attention to that gap.

food security and social services. That communication cited the UN Charter's entry into force on 24 October 1945 as the basis for the anniversary.

The commemoration took place while several regional conflicts tested the Security Council's capacity to respond. The symbolic anniversary therefore coincided with a practical argument over how international institutions manage disagreement among powerful states.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. UN Day falls on 24 October.
2. The UN Charter entered into force in 1945.
3. The Secretary-General's 2026 message prioritised international law and cooperation.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / Current Affairs — UN system, collective security and international law

SOURCES [12] · [13]

MIDDLE EAST / HUMANITARIAN LAW

West Bank raids displace families near Hebron

Israeli forces intensified operations after two soldiers were killed; Palestinian officials raised objections.

On Saturday, 24 October 2026, Israeli forces carried out raids and arrests in the occupied West Bank while an operation around Hebron prompted evacuations and new movement restrictions. Al Jazeera reported operations in multiple northern towns, including Nablus, Jenin, Tubas and Qalqilya.

The action followed an attack near Hebron in which two Israeli soldiers were killed. Israeli officials said the military operation sought armed suspects and weapons and argued that further security measures were necessary. Palestinian officials objected to the displacement of residents and the effect of closed roads, homes and businesses.

Dawn reported that an Israeli defence official said about 2,000 people had been displaced, while Palestinian local officials gave accounts of affected households and threatened demolitions. These numbers came from the named parties and should not be confused with an independently completed population assessment.

The timing was sensitive because Israeli voters were due to elect the next Knesset on 27 October. Electoral incentives may influence the political debate, but the sources do not establish the motive for every operational decision.

BACKGROUND Hebron is in the occupied West Bank, where checkpoints, settlement expansion and competing security claims shape daily movement. International law and civilian protection remain central to diplomatic discussion.

ANALYSIS Operations following an armed attack raise separate questions about legitimate security objectives, proportionality, civilian displacement and the protection of people not directly involved in violence.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Israeli forces carried out West Bank raids on 24 October.
2. The actions followed an attack that killed two Israeli soldiers.
3. Israeli elections were scheduled for 27 October 2026.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / International Law — occupation, civilian protection and proportionality

SOURCES [14] · [15] · [24]

ENVIRONMENT / SCIENCE POLICY

Biodiversity science forum opens at COP17

Yerevan meetings addressed how research and monitoring can support national conservation decisions.

On Saturday, 24 October 2026, the seventh Science–Policy Forum for Biodiversity opened in Yerevan, Armenia, alongside the seventeenth meeting of the Conference of the Parties to the Convention on Biological Diversity. The International Union of Biological Sciences scheduled the forum for 24–25 October.

The event brought science and policy participants together to consider turning biodiversity research into actions by governments and other institutions. Scheduled subjects included monitoring ecosystems, data quality, scientific cooperation, agriculture, health and biodiversity implementation.

A session announced by Germany's International Climate Initiative and partner organisations focused on monitoring ecosystem services. The agenda called attention to the availability and interpretation of ecological data and to the possible benefits and limits of artificial intelligence in environmental monitoring.

The COP17 host calendar also listed a capacity-building forum on 24 October and a biodiversity finance day later in the week. These parallel events were designed to support implementation of international conservation commitments, not to substitute for formal negotiations among governments.

BACKGROUND COP17 is part of the Convention on Biological Diversity process. The Kunming–Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework sets international goals and targets intended to halt and reverse nature loss.

ANALYSIS Monitoring matters because commitments cannot be assessed without credible baselines and repeatable observations. Data gaps and financing constraints can weaken the connection between agreed targets and implementation.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. The Science–Policy Forum was scheduled for 24–25 October in Yerevan.
2. COP17 concerns the Convention on Biological Diversity.
3. A 24 October session addressed ecosystem monitoring and environmental data use.

CSS ANGLE Environmental Science / Current Affairs — biodiversity governance and scientific monitoring

SOURCES [16] · [17] · [18]

GULF / MILITARY DIPLOMACY

Iran warns against renewed US naval approach

A senior Iranian commander made a fresh maritime warning amid stalled talks and US pressure.

On Saturday, 24 October 2026, Iranian chief of general staff Ali Abdollahi said Iran's armed forces were prepared to target US warships approaching Iranian waters. The statement, reported by Al Jazeera from Iranian state media, accompanied warnings about the possibility of further American military action.

Abdollahi argued that Iranian military capabilities could prevent US forces from moving closer to the country. His comments were a statement of Iran's position and military claims, not independent

BACKGROUND The Persian Gulf and Strait of Hormuz connect major energy-producing states with global markets. Maritime freedom, territorial waters and shipping security are recurring issues in regional disputes.

ANALYSIS Military deterrence claims can escalate a crisis by

evidence that Tehran controlled every shipping lane in the Persian Gulf.

The warning came amid unsuccessful mediation efforts and increased regional tension. Diplomats from regional states and European countries had met in Istanbul a day earlier and called for restraint and negotiations. That earlier meeting supplies background to Saturday's new Iranian statement.

Maritime tensions can affect insurers, shipping schedules and energy markets even without an actual closure of routes. The Strait of Hormuz remains a central point of concern when US–Iran confrontation raises the perceived risk to commercial navigation.

narrowing the room for compromise. The practical question is whether diplomatic channels can separate threats from verifiable maritime incidents and arrangements for safe transit.

THREE REVISION POINTS

1. Ali Abdollahi made the warning on Saturday, 24 October.
2. It concerned US naval vessels approaching Iranian waters.
3. The Istanbul diplomatic discussions had taken place on Friday, 23 October.

CSS ANGLE International Relations / Current Affairs — Gulf geopolitics, deterrence and energy routes

SOURCES [19]

NEXT SEVEN DAYS

26 October COP17 Finance and Biodiversity Day in Yerevan. [18]

27 October Elections for Israel's 26th Knesset. [24]

27–28 October US Federal Open Market Committee meeting. [23]

29 October COP17 Judges' Day parallel programme. [18]

30 October Scheduled final day of COP17 in Yerevan. [18]

03 GENERAL KNOWLEDGE

01 SECURITY Aden is the seat of Yemen's internationally recognised government. [1]

02 GULF Saudi authorities reported intercepting ballistic missiles on 24 October 2026. [1] [2]

03 TRADE Gabd–Rimdan is a Pakistan–Iran border crossing in Gwadar district. [4]

04 TRADE The Gabd–Rimdan crossing is also called Gate 250. [4]

05 WATER Wapda's HM-1 contract for Diamer-Bhasha was worth Rs133.18bn. [5]

06 ENERGY Diamer-Bhasha's stated installed generation capacity is 4,500MW upon completion. [5]

07 WATER Diamer-Bhasha's stated gross storage capacity is 8.1 million acre-feet. [5]

08 GOVERNANCE Pakistan Railways' 24 October safety emergency was set through 31 December. [6]

09 DIPLOMACY Pakistan and Canada concluded a third round of investment treaty negotiations on 24 October. [8] [9]

10 LAW Investor–state dispute settlement was among the topics in the Canada–Pakistan negotiations. [9]

11 ECONOMY The SBP policy rate was 11.50% under the 14 September 2026 decision. [20]

12 ECONOMY The rupee closed at Rs276.82 per US dollar on 23 October 2026. [21]

13 MARKETS The KSE-100 stood at 162,374.87

14 UN The UN Charter entered into force on 24

points at the 23 October 2026 close. [22]

15 UN United Nations Day was observed for the 81st time since 1945 in 2026. [12] [13]

16 SCIENCE COP17 was held in Yerevan, Armenia, in October 2026. [16] [18]

17 SCIENCE The seventh biodiversity Science–Policy Forum was scheduled for 24–25 October 2026. [16]

18 SECURITY Raids were reported in at least 15 West Bank towns on 24 October. [14]

19 ELECTIONS Israel's 26th Knesset election was scheduled for 27 October 2026. [24]

20 FINANCE The US Federal Reserve had scheduled a meeting for 27–28 October 2026. [23]

04 FIVE TERMS

01 / CONSTITUTION / POLITICAL SCIENCE

Bicameralism

A bicameral legislature has two chambers rather than one. The chambers may differ in composition, constituencies or legislative powers.

WHY IT MATTERS It matters because representation and lawmaking procedures often balance population-based and territorial interests.

EXAMPLE Pakistan's Parliament consists of the National Assembly and Senate under Article 50 of the 1973 Constitution. Source [25]

02 / INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Diplomatic immunity

Diplomatic immunity protects diplomatic agents from specified forms of jurisdiction in the receiving state. Its rules are intended to allow diplomatic missions to function independently and are not an unlimited personal licence.

WHY IT MATTERS It matters because interstate relations require privileges balanced by obligations under treaty law.

EXAMPLE The 1961 Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations established the main treaty framework and entered into force in 1964. Source [26]

03 / ECONOMY / PUBLIC FINANCE

Automatic stabilisers

Automatic stabilisers are tax and spending arrangements that respond to changing economic conditions without a new discretionary decision. During a downturn, lower tax receipts or higher unemployment benefits can soften the fall in demand.

WHY IT MATTERS They matter for the design of fiscal systems that respond promptly to economic shocks.

EXAMPLE OECD economic analysis has used unemployment benefits and progressive income taxation as standing examples. Source [27]

04 / LAW / PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

Ombudsman

An ombudsman examines complaints concerning improper or unfair public administration. The institution provides administrative redress within powers set by law rather than replacing the courts.

WHY IT MATTERS It matters because access to remedies and oversight affect the quality of public service delivery.

EXAMPLE Pakistan established the federal Wafaqi Mohtasib through President's Order No. 1 of 1983. Source [28]

05 / ENVIRONMENT / SCIENCE

Radiative forcing

Radiative forcing describes a change in Earth's balance between incoming and outgoing energy caused by a factor such as a greenhouse gas or an aerosol. Positive forcing tends toward warming while negative forcing tends toward cooling.

WHY IT MATTERS It matters because climate policies require a physical account of what changes global temperature.

EXAMPLE NASA explains how high thin clouds can create warming forcing while low thick clouds can produce cooling. Source [29]

05 PRACTICE

Q01. Which city is the seat of Yemen's internationally recognised government?

A. Sanaa
B. Aden
C. Taiz
D. Hodeida

Q02. Which Pakistan–Iran crossing reopened to goods traffic on 24 October?

A. Gabd–Rimdan
B. Torkham
C. Wagah
D. Khunjerab

Q03. How much was the announced Diamer-Bhasha HM-1 contract?

A. Rs13.318bn
B. Rs33.18bn
C. Rs133.18bn
D. Rs313.18bn

Q04. In which city did Aurangzeb speak on export-led growth?

A. Islamabad
B. Karachi
C. Quetta
D. Lahore

Q05. Which anniversary of the UN Charter entering into force was marked in 2026?

A. 81st
B. 75th
C. 85th
D. 80th

Q06. How long was the Pakistan Railways safety emergency scheduled to last?

A. To 24 November
B. To 31 December
C. To 31 October
D. To 30 January

Q07. Which two states concluded the third round of BIT talks in Islamabad?

A. Pakistan and China
B. Pakistan and Turkey
C. Pakistan and Canada
D. Pakistan and Iran

Q08. What did Pakistan's finance minister identify as the preferred growth model?

A. Import-led consumption
B. Credit-fuelled demand
C. Protected domestic sales
D. Competitive export-led growth

Q09. What is the stated installed capacity of Diamer-Bhasha when complete?

A. 4,500MW
B. 3,500MW
C. 5,400MW
D. 2,500MW

Q10. Where was the 2026 biodiversity Science–Policy Forum held?

A. Geneva
B. Yerevan
C. Montreal
D. Nairobi

Q11. Which of these is a provision used in automatic fiscal stabilisation?

A. Fixed port tariff
B. Emergency trade ban
C. Unemployment benefit rule
D. One-off defence grant

Q12. Which chamber pair makes Pakistan's Parliament bicameral?

A. Senate and cabinet
B. Courts and Senate
C. Council and cabinet
D. Senate and National Assembly

Q13. Which report category best describes the finance minister's $21.5bn statement?

A. Current-year external debt payments
B. Annual tax revenues
C. Central bank assets
D. Budgeted health spending

Q14. Which legal instrument is central to modern diplomatic immunity?

A. Hague Convention of 1907
B. Vienna Convention of 1961
C. Geneva Convention of 1949
D. Rome Statute of 1998

Q15. Why must 4,500MW for Diamer-Bhasha not be described as current generation?

A. It is an export limit
B. It is a market price
C. It is planned installed capacity
D. It measures annual inflow

ANSWER KEY

01 B Yemen's internationally recognised government operates from Aden. [1]

02 A The Gabd–Rimdan crossing in Gwadar reopened on Saturday. [4]

03 C The announcement specified Rs133.18bn for the HM-1 contract. [5]

04 D The forum was held at LUMS in Lahore. [3]

05 A The UN Charter entered into force on 24 October 1945, 81 years earlier. [12][13]

06 B The Railway Ministry said the emergency would continue through 31 December. [6]

07 C Pakistan and Canada concluded a third round of BIT negotiations. [8]

08 D The minister explicitly favoured export-led growth over demand-fuelled expansion. [3]

09 A Wapda cited 4,500MW as the project's installed capacity on completion. [5]

10 B The biodiversity science forum met in Yerevan during COP17. [16]

11 C Eligibility-based unemployment benefits rise with unemployment without a fresh law. [27]

12 D Article 50 describes Parliament as including the National Assembly and Senate. [25]

13 A The minister described the $21.5bn amount as current-year external debt payments. [3]

14 B The Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations was adopted in 1961. [26]

15 C Installed design capacity after completion is not electricity generated today. [5]

06 REFERENCES

01 Al Jazeera, 24 Oct 2026, Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia and Aden

02 Dawn, 25 Oct 2026, coalition and Houthi strikes

03 Dawn, 24 Oct 2026, Aurangzeb on export-led growth

04 Dawn, 25 Oct 2026, Gabd border trade resumes

05 Dawn, 25 Oct 2026, Diamer-Bhasha hydro-mechanical contract

06 Radio Pakistan, 24 Oct 2026, rail safety emergency

07 Dawn, 25 Oct 2026, Pakistan Railways response

08 Pakistan PID, 24 Oct 2026, Pakistan–Canada investment negotiations

09 Dawn, 25 Oct 2026, investment treaty negotiating round

10 Radio Pakistan, 24 Oct 2026, Pakistan–Afghanistan statement

11 Dawn, 24 Oct 2026, Pakistan replies to Kabul

12 UN Bosnia and Herzegovina, 24 Oct 2026, Secretary-General message

13 UN Malawi, 24 Oct 2026, United Nations Day statement

14 Al Jazeera, 24 Oct 2026, West Bank military operations

15 Dawn, 25 Oct 2026, Hebron and West Bank displacement

16 IUBS, 24–25 Oct 2026, biodiversity science-policy forum

17 Germany IKI, 24 Oct 2026, ecosystem monitoring forum

18 COP17 host, parallel-events calendar, October 2026

19 Al Jazeera, 24 Oct 2026, Iranian military maritime warning

20 SBP, monetary policy rate, 14 Sep 2026 decision

21 Business Recorder, 23 Oct 2026, USD/PKR close

22 Pakistan Stock Exchange, KSE-100 close, 23 Oct 2026

23 US Federal Reserve, October 2026 FOMC calendar

24 Israeli election commission, election date 27 Oct 2026

25 National Assembly of Pakistan, bicameral parliament

26 UN International Law Commission, Vienna convention overview

27 OECD, automatic fiscal stabilisers, 2019 outlook

28 Federal Ombudsman, meaning and jurisdiction of maladministration

29 NASA, clouds and Earth energy balance